

The One Hundred and Eight Names of the Glorious Black Goddess

Śrī Devī Kālinā Nāma Aṣṭaśataka · Toh 672 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་ལྷ་སྒྲོག་མའོ་མཚན་བར་རྒྱ་མཚན་པ།

Toh 672 in the Kangyur is a tantric text known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Devī Kālinā Nāma Aṣṭaśataka and in Tibetan as the One Hundred and Eight Names of the Glorious Black Goddess. As its title indicates, the text is a collection of one hundred and eight names or epithets of the Glorious Black Goddess, a powerful wrathful female deity, presented in the form of a discourse delivered by the Buddha on Vulture Peak Mountain before an assembly of bodhisattvas. The setting follows a classical tantric sūtra structure, in which a bodhisattva interlocutor prompts the Buddha to reveal the names of this goddess together with their significance in terms of cause and result. The opening lines also indicate that this text concludes a larger cycle called the Tantra of the King of Praises, suggesting it forms part of a broader collection of devotional and tantric literature within the Kangyur.

With great delight, the Blessed One rained down a great shower of ornaments upon Vajrapāṇi, and all took their respective places. The Tantra of the King of Praises is complete.

In the language of India: Śrī Devī Kālinā Nāma Aṣṭaśataka. In the Tibetan language: The One Hundred and Eight Names of the Glorious Black Goddess.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling on Vulture Peak Mountain, revealing to all bodhisattvas the names of suchness according to cause and result. At that time, the great Glorious Black Goddess herself approached the Blessed One, circumambulated him three times, and sat down to one side in the presence of the Blessed One.

Then the bodhisattva Lion's Diligence addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what are the various names by which this bodhisattva, who appears in the guise of a demoness and accomplishes the welfare of worldly beings, is known?" In response, the Blessed One, with the bodhisattva Lion's Diligence in mind, gazed upon the Glorious Black Goddess and spoke thus:

She who deeply abides in hearing, reflection, and meditation,
whose very nature is cause, result, and condition,
the supreme wise one who works for the benefit of beings —
the noble Glorious Black Goddess.

She is an emanation of a bodhisattva,
a ground as stable and steady as the earth,
like water gathering all good qualities,
like fire that ripens awakening.

She stirs the formations of virtue like the wind.
Her pure wisdom is like the sky.
You are like the great elements.
Praised by the great multitude of spirits,

skilled in karma and karmic ripening,
perfected through the vast accumulation of merit and primordial wisdom,
practiced in taming those whose form is pride,
she walks the path of wisdom and compassion.

You are like a fine vase.
Like the water of a wish-fulfilling jewel,
like the wish-fulfilling tree that benefits all —
in you shines the likeness of the sun.

She possesses a mind that shines like the moon.
Her name is like the horn of a hare —
her own continuum is like a wheel.
Though rare as the udumbara flower,

she satisfies completely like ambrosia.
She is the sovereign of all beings,
and teaches the Dharma of no inherent nature.
Like a storm of water and sky,

she tames her disciples through all three realms by whatever means.
She guards the teaching of the Victors of the three times,
truly one with the holy ones,
she walks on the path of the holy ones.

Goddess, mother spirit, female yakṣa,
demoness, nāginī, flesh-eater,
fierce one, elemental spirit, kumbhāṇḍī,

wrathful one, menacing in manner, she who flashes like lightning,
wind spirit, black one, bringer of fear,
ḍākinī, the fierce one, liberatrix of the field.

Through peace, enrichment, power, and wrathful means she tames.
She appears in white, yellow, green, black, and red.
She arises in the shapes of the eight forms,
and also manifests the modes of the six classes of beings.
She can speak of the five aggregates,
and reveals the five sense objects that satisfy the sense faculties.
She is skilled in the conduct of dependent origination.

She is skilled in slaying those who are objects of perception,
and likewise in slaying all speech,
and strives to slay those who possess bodies.
She is skilled in there being no slaying of mind —
she has gone far from saṃsāra.

Prophesied by the Tathāgata,
she bears the names of a bodhisattva.
The Glorious One who protects the world
loves those who uphold the holy Dharma.

Oṃ āḥ hūṃ śrī devī kālī samaya jaḥ ḍāginī ḍāya samaya svāhā.

Whoever holds these one hundred and eight names
will also attain one hundred and eight qualities.
They will not experience the sufferings of hell,
will not be born in the realm of hungry ghosts,
and will not be hindered by birth as an animal.
When born in a noble realm as a human,
lightning and the like will not strike them,
nor will the wind bring unpleasant sounds.
Likewise, they cannot be swept away by water and waves even in a
cattle-pasturing place.
Whoever is born on Jambudvīpa —

they will not be threatened by various harms. Even in the realms of the gods of
desire, when born there they will delight in the Dharma. In the birthplaces of
the four meditative concentrations, the four immeasurables will increase. In
the four formless realms as well, they will not be born without purpose, nor will

they ever be born in the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception. In the places where noble ones dwell, they will pursue their own welfare in accordance with the way of the three realms. They will never become attached to sense objects, and will not grasp at the mind. The six root afflictions and likewise the twenty secondary afflictions, as well as the five acts of immediate consequence, will all be purified. For many countless eons they will not be born in the eight states of no leisure. They will repel the disputes of non-Buddhists, be endowed with magnificent power and strength, live long and free from illness, and be possessed of splendor. For many eons, without suffering, they will never fall into cyclic existence. In order to attain nirvāṇa, they will traverse the śrāvaka grounds, and will come to know the twelve links of dependent origination. The bodhisattva grounds — Joyful, Stainless, Luminous, Radiant, Hard to Train, Manifest, Gone Afar, Immovable, Excellent Wisdom, Cloud of Dharma, the Great Buddha Ground, and the Unsurpassed — all twelve they will attain. And all these grounds: the ground of universal light, the ground of nectar-light, the ground of sky-light, the ground of vajra-light, the ground of jewel-light, the ground of lotus-light, the ground of karma-light, the ground of incomparable wisdom, the ground of glorious splendor, the ground of wisdom-light, omniscience, and self-knowing awareness — all twelve buddha grounds, should they arise in this very lifetime, will be swiftly attained. Even before attaining these grounds, they will benefit beings, be endowed with wisdom and compassion, and be protected by those who delight in the Dharma. They will attain siddhis and will receive the Tathāgata-born precious attainment. Whoever holds these one hundred and eight names of the glorious bodhisattva and the glorious Great Black Goddess will attain one hundred and eight qualities. Having perfected body, speech, and mind, they will become the sovereign of Dharma in the three realms.

When this was declared, the retinue of bodhisattvas and the great glorious Great Black Goddess were filled with wonder, and they rejoiced in what the Blessed One had proclaimed.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase "兔角" — "her name is like the horn of a hare" — is a standard Buddhist image for something conventionally designated but lacking inherent existence, analogous to a rabbit's horn. The verse uses it to gesture at the emptiness underlying even the goddess's own name.

The passage on "slaying" — those with objects of perception, speech, and bodies — is a doctrinal riddle typical of tantric literature: she slays ego-grasping, conceptual speech, and

attachment to the body, but "there is no slaying of mind" because the ultimate nature of mind is beyond destruction. This reading follows the commentarial tradition.

The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, indicating the passage is incomplete as given.

- The list of twelve bodhisattva grounds given here does not map straightforwardly onto the standard ten-ground system of mainstream Mahāyāna literature. The text appears to enumerate a twelve-ground scheme that conflates the ordinary ten bodhisattva grounds with additional buddha grounds, likely reflecting a Vajrayāna or specific tantric textual tradition. The names of the twelve grounds in the second list — universal light, nectar-light, sky-light, vajra-light, jewel-light, lotus-light, karma-light, incomparable wisdom, glorious splendor, wisdom-light, omniscience, and self-knowing awareness — are non-standard and appear to be a distinct, possibly tantric enumeration rather than the classical Daśabhūmika list; this has been rendered faithfully without harmonizing to the standard schema.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.